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ADRIANA ZEBRAUSKAS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Kiana Barroso and daughter Ruby Jane, 2, in Glendale, Ariz. She lost her benefits in April, and struggles to feed her family.

Faced With Mounds of Paperwork, People Are Losing Food Stamps

Eligible for Aid, but Cut Loose as States Try to Avoid Penalties for Mistakes

By JASON DePARLE

MESA, Ariz. — The number of Arizonans getting SNAP benefits has fallen by about half in less than a year, a remarkable drop in nutrition aid that may preview the program’s future nationwide following a landmark law to limit assistance that President Trump championed last year.

Many of the 440,000 Arizonans dropped from the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program — food stamps — remain eligible for help. But the new law establishes steep penalties on states that make too many mistakes when awarding benefits. To avoid those costs, which are so large that state officials say they could end the program, Arizona increased the paperwork that applicants must file, even as it cut the staff to review it.

The result, aid-seekers and officials both say, has been bureaucratic chaos.

It can take months to reach besieged caseworkers, and offices have gone as far as asking people with panhandling income for verification from strangers dropping cash in their jar. Arizonans

losing SNAP say they are skipping meals, quarreling over food, and missing rent payments to restock pantry shelves. For the first time, monthly visits to the state’s food banks — private charities — have exceeded enrollment in SNAP, the government’s main nutrition safety net.

Arizona took especially quick and aggressive steps to combat errors, and its caseload declines may prove much larger than those elsewhere. But with other states facing the same penalties, Arizona’s experience as an early test case is being scrutinized for clues to future trends.

Among the Arizonans who lost SNAP is Dee McDonald, who is raising three grandsons in a trim cottage in Mesa with a list of family rules that include “Be Thankful.” Last October, Ms. McDonald, 65, tried to renew a \$700 monthly SNAP benefit that supplements Social Security and provides a third of her income.

In November, no aid arrived. In December, a caseworker said to “hang in there” because renewals were months behind. In January,

Continued on Page A18

Spain Revels in Glory in the Soccer World, Among Other Spheres

By JASON HOROWITZ

MADRID — After Spain won the soccer World Cup, Lucia Sánchez joined a boisterous river of fans clad in red-and-yellow jerseys early Monday in Madrid and took stock of the special time her country was enjoying.

“We’re in a good moment,” Ms. Sánchez, 22, said outside Madrid’s packed Plaza de Colón, as the nearby crowds sang “I am Spanish, Spanish, Spanish.” So many facets of life seemed to be going Spain’s way, and “other countries realize that,” she said. “It all goes together.”

By winning the world championship, only three years after their female counterparts did the same, the Spanish players have bolstered the sense that — amid a broader cultural, economic and sports renaissance — something promising is happening in Spain, and that to be here now is to be in the right place, at the right time.

Spain has a housing crisis, and its government is embattled by corruption scandals, dampening any unqualified triumphalism. Still, its strong economy is the envy of much of Europe, and last year it accounted for more than 40 percent of the jobs created in the European Union. It is far ahead of much of the West in converting to renewable energy, attracting investors seeking to build data centers and other industries hoping



JOSEPH FOX FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

WORLD CUP’S LEGACY How the lessons of this year’s tournament could reshape the future. Page B6.

to feed off its cheaper electricity.

In the cultural sphere, Spain is also firing on all cylinders. Spanish cinema has entered a new and more diverse era, spurring high praise abroad. Javier Ambrossi and Javier Calvo, a former couple known simply as Los Javis, won best-director honors in Cannes this year and received a 20-

minute standing ovation, the second longest in the festival’s history. Rosalía, a Barcelona chanteuse, is helping to drive a shift away from English-language songs on Spotify, the music streaming platform.

Foreigners are visiting Spain in ever larger numbers — the government expects a record 100 mil-

lion tourists this year — and the capital city, Madrid, is booming with new restaurants, exhibits, expats and energy. One recent visitor was Pope Leo, who spent a feel-good week in Spain in June and congratulated the Madrid church on scoring a “spectacular goal” as his appearances drew

Continued on Page A6

THE WEATHER

Today, showers and a storm, high 78. Tonight, showers and a heavy thunderstorm, low 73. Tomorrow, partly cloudy, widely separated storms, high 83. Weather map, Page A24.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Trump Traps G.O.P. in Box On Iran War

Little Oversight in an
Unpopular Conflict

By ROBERT JIMISON

WASHINGTON — President Trump has yet again circumvented the legislative branch as he has ordered American forces back into combat in the Middle East, weeks after both chambers of Congress rebuked him for waging war with Iran without authorization.

The collapse of the cease-fire and resumption of hostilities have inflamed a debate on Capitol Hill over war powers just as the administration has sought tens of billions of dollars to pay for the conflict.

That has presented Republicans with a political worst-case scenario months before midterm elections in which their majorities are at stake: They are being asked to vote to fund an unpopular war over which they have had no meaningful oversight, and which they have never voted to approve.

“The greatest fighting force on the planet, the last great superpower must be fully equipped, and that’s the job of Congress to make sure it’s done,” Speaker Mike Johnson told CNN’s Manu Raju last week at the Capitol. The administration last month requested \$87.6 billion in supplemental funding that would include \$67.1 billion in extra military spending this year.

Asked whether it wasn’t also the job of Congress to authorize the war, Mr. Johnson replied, “We’re going to supply the needs for America’s national security.”

The position amounts to the latest instance of Republicans’ ceding power to the executive branch, as they sidestep a debate over the conduct of the war and try to rally support within their ranks for a filibuster-proof,

Continued on Page A9



ALEX KENT/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Speaker Mike Johnson voiced no qualms about extra funding.

Tilt to Ukraine In War Draws Investors’ Eyes

Shift Away From Focus
on Donor Assistance

By ANDREW E. KRAMER

GDANSK, Poland — The mood has shifted on the war in Ukraine. Just ask the businessmen who sipped cocktails and toasted deals one recent evening at a party outside a hip dockside cafe.

The party followed a conference in Gdansk, Poland, on the postwar reconstruction of Ukraine. Previous gatherings revolved around donor assistance. This year, the emphasis was private investment — a view of Ukraine not as a battered victim but as a large postwar market on a path to European Union membership.

The change was a sign of a more upbeat assessment among diplomats, military analysts and businessmen of Kyiv’s prospects in the war. The front line is still a crucible of drone-fueled violence, and Russian missiles continue to hit Ukrainian cities. But Russia’s advances have been mostly halted, and Ukraine is hitting back, including with strikes on Moscow.

The overarching pitch at the conference was to put money into Ukraine even as it remains at war. Any such investment is a wager that Ukraine will deny Russia its broad ambitions in the conflict and remain an independent state.

Among the 7,500 attendees was Jeremy Lewin, the State Department’s under secretary for foreign assistance and humanitarian affairs. In a speech, he said this was the moment to “invest in the dip” in Ukraine — to buy in now, when prices are lower, and profit as the country rises.

The conference produced 160 agreements that netted Ukraine about \$11 billion in private investment and aid, according to Yuliia Svyrydenko, who until last week was Ukraine’s prime minister.

The Export-Import Bank of the United States announced an up to \$300 million line of credit for Naftogaz, Ukraine’s state oil and gas company, to buy American construction equipment and oil industry services.

For now, Ukraine’s economy is propped up by international aid. But the country’s long-term prospects are potentially lucrative. Ukraine holds one of Europe’s largest known reserves of natural gas, with an estimated value of about \$300 billion.

“People are looking at serious business opportunities” in Ukraine, said Duncan Nightingale, the chairman of the board of Naftogaz. The forum buzzed with “a very high level of optimism,” he said.

Continued on Page A7

Promise of Genetic Risk Tools Is Lacking for People of Color

By EMILY BAUMGAERTNER NUNN

The National Institutes of Health recently announced a remarkable achievement: the world’s largest database of human genomes, a repository of information that the agency says will help usher in a new era in personalized medicine.

Scientists are already developing clinical tools and techniques based on genomic information gathered from the agency’s All of Us program. One of the most promising? Polygenic risk scores. These can help predict a person’s likelihood of developing complex diseases, like cardiovascular disease and breast cancer, from as early as infancy.

But there’s a glaring problem: The tools were trained overwhelmingly on the DNA of people of European descent, so they often fail to accurately assess risks for

anyone else. For some conditions, the forecasts for people of color are almost no better than flipping a coin.

Researchers are racing to correct the biases through advancements in modeling and widespread recruitment of minority groups. They fear that failing to close the gaps could worsen health care disparities — and prevent the technology from realizing its promise of helping to decrease chronic disease.

“It really warrants attention,” said Eimear Kenny, the director of the Institute for Genomic Health at Mount Sinai and a principal investigator in a national consortium that tests the genetic scores.

Geneticists measure a polygenic risk score by aggregating hundreds or thousands of tiny

Continued on Page A10



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Andy Burnham’s First Day

On Monday, Britain’s seventh leader in a decade demonstrated how he plans to govern differently.

PAGE A6

Men in Shorts Shake Up Japan

Tokyo is allowing workers to wear shorts for the first time this summer, prompting delicate questions.

PAGE A4

NATIONAL A12-21

Black Politicians Regroup

With the Voting Rights Act weakened, Black candidates focus on broad, multi-racial appeal or on ideological outsider campaigns.

PAGE A12

Judges: Our Landlord Stinks

Federal courthouses need billions in repairs. Judges say the government is not doing enough to respond.

PAGE A16

SPORTS B6-10

The Fastest Miler’s Formula

Josh Kerr broke the world record using bespoke spikes, teamwork, altitude training and attitude.

PAGE B10



BUSINESS B1-5

A Chicken-and-Egg Problem

China consumes more eggs per capita than most countries, so a recent spike in costs is touching a nerve.

PAGE B1

Judge Pauses Paramount Deal

The delay is intended to provide time to consider a lawsuit that argues the merger violates antitrust laws.

PAGE B5

SCIENCE TIMES D1-8

The Worshipers of Odysseus

What remains of a 2,400-year-old complex in Ithaca suggests that, to the Greeks of antiquity, Homer’s hero was not just a character in a poem but a figure of genuine devotion.

PAGE D1

It Came From Outer Space

A New Jersey couple helped scientists uncover the makeup of an asteroid after it fell into their bedroom. A study published last week reveals that the space rock is no ordinary specimen.

PAGE D1

OPINION A22-23

Jessica Grose

PAGE A23



ARTS C1-6

In the Thrall of Nature

An exhibition of the work of Ana Mendieta in London shows how she stretched the boundaries of making, showing and understanding art.

PAGE C1



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